

BBC 6 Minute English Listening Practice

What Causes Hearing Loss?

Name: _____

Class: _____

Score: _____ / 30

No.	Sentence
1	The ear consists of _____ main parts
2	Located on the _____ of your head
3	Functions like a satellite dish to _____ sounds
4	Directs sounds towards the _____
5	Contains an _____ that vibrates
6	Its primary function is to _____ sounds
7	Houses the three _____ bones in the body
8	Contains _____ that receive sound vibrations
9	Sends _____ to the brain
10	Damage to hearing begins from approximately the age of _____
11	The _____ you inherit at birth
12	The _____ you are exposed to
13	Example: certain occupations may cause a _____ decline in hearing
14	The brain performs extensive _____ to process speech
15	As hearing deteriorates, the brain raises its _____
16	People often don't notice they have difficulty hearing because it's a _____ process
17	Using _____

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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No.	Sentence
18	Undergoing _____
19	Removing excess _____
20	The smallest bone in the human body is the _____ bone

What is Georgie's attitude towards the increasing prevalence of hearing loss?

- A She expresses skepticism about the statistical data provided
- B She shows concern about the growing scale of the problem
- C She demonstrates relief that it only affects elderly people
- D She appears indifferent to the health implications involved

According to Nish Mehta, what is the primary function of the pinna?

- A To vibrate in response to different sound frequencies
- B To protect the inner structures from external damage
- C To transmit electrical signals directly to the brain
- D To gather sound waves and channel them inward

What can be inferred about the middle ear's role in the hearing process?

- A It strengthens sound vibrations before passing them forward
- B It filters out harmful frequencies to protect the brain
- C It converts mechanical movements into electrical impulses
- D It serves primarily as a protective barrier for delicate tissues

Why does James Gallagher exclaim 'So, we're doomed already!'?

- A He is surprised that genetics play such a minor role
- B He realizes that environmental factors cannot be controlled
- C He is shocked that hearing deterioration begins so early
- D He discovers that surgery cannot reverse the damage

According to Nish Mehta, what determines how quickly someone's hearing deteriorates?

- A Only the genetic predisposition inherited from parents
- B A combination of inherited traits and environmental exposure
- C Primarily the type of occupation they choose in life
- D The amount of medical intervention received in childhood

What does Nish Mehta suggest about people working with pneumatic drills?

- A They may experience faster hearing decline despite strong genetics
- B They should avoid all noisy environments outside of work
- C They are guaranteed to develop complete hearing loss
- D They typically have weaker genetic protection than others

According to Nish Mehta, why do people often fail to notice their hearing problems?

- A Medical check-ups are not sensitive enough to detect changes
- B Social situations mask the severity of the condition
- C Hearing loss only affects specific frequencies initially
- D The brain gradually compensates, making decline less obvious

What does the phrase 'redundancy in the system' imply about human hearing?

- A The ear has unnecessary components that serve no purpose
- B Multiple pathways exist to prevent complete hearing failure
- C The brain cannot adequately compensate for damaged ears
- D Alternative backup mechanisms are built into the auditory system

What is Georgie's opinion about removing ear wax as a treatment?

- A She finds it an unappealing procedure to perform
- B She believes it is the most effective solution available
- C She questions whether it actually improves hearing significantly
- D She thinks it should be combined with surgical intervention

What is Neil's attitude when revealing the correct answer to his question?

- A He is apologetic about Georgie's incorrect response
- B He adopts a playfully teasing tone toward Georgie
- C He expresses genuine disappointment in her knowledge
- D He shows frustration at her lack of attention